BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #22 · BRAIN CHEMISTRY AND MENTAL ILLNESS

"I'm broken and can't be fixed."

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Where it often comes from

Years of struggle and failed attempts to feel better can convince us that we are beyond repair. We may stop seeking help or keep it at arm's length.

What Scripture teaches

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." "A bruised reed He will not break, and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish" (Isaiah 42:3). "We have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us. We are hard pressed on all sides, but not crushed" (2 Corinthians 4:7–8). "He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion." Healing may be gradual and incomplete, but you are not beyond God's care or good treatment.

> *"A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice"* (Isaiah 42:3).

Also see

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

> "Now we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us" (2 Corinthians 4:7).

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

Common self-statements

- I am beyond repair.
- Nothing can fix me.
- I have tried everything.
- I am a lost cause.
- I will always be broken.
- Why keep trying?

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fixed or hopeless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never heal.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling broken and concluding that I am beyond repair.
- Labeling: Calling myself broken.

Challenging questions

- What has helped, even a little?
- What have I not tried yet?

- Who could offer fresh perspective, such as a counselor, pastor, or doctor?
- What does God do with bruised reeds?
- What does “fixed” look like, and is “better” enough?
- What small step can I take now?

Truth summary

> God does not break a bruised reed. I may be hurt, but I am not beyond help. Healing can be gradual, and I can keep taking steps with His help and the help of others.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Therapy
- Suffering
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ’s resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm broken and can't be fixed"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm broken and can't be fixed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has helped, even a little?
- ☐ What have I not tried yet?
- ☐ Who could offer fresh perspective, such as a counselor, pastor, or doctor?
- ☐ What does God do with bruised reeds?
- ☐ What does "fixed" look like, and is "better" enough?
- ☐ What small step can I take now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He will not break a bruised reed.
- ☐ I am a jar of clay holding treasure.
- ☐ God will complete His work in me.
- ☐ Improvement is possible.
- ☐ I am not beyond help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 42:3
  "A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:7
  "Now we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Steps toward healing: Each week, note one thing that helped.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 42:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord will not break a bruised reed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List what helped. Write even small things.
- [ ] Try one new help. Counseling, support group, or doctor.
- [ ] Be patient. Healing takes time.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 42:3. Remember God's gentleness.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm broken and can't be fixed": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Steps toward healing
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm broken and can't be fixed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel broken. Thank You that You do not break bruised reeds. Heal me gently, in Your time, and lead me to the help I need. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.